

New Cub Scout Parent Orientation

Engage, Include & Empower New Scout Families in Your Pack

A leader's guide to turning new families into active contributors — from day one.

THE OPPORTUNITY

The Common Mistake

- Treat new parents as observers
- Assign only simple tasks (snacks, carpool)
- Overwhelm them with info without connection
- Leave them feeling like outsiders

The Better Approach

- Discover each family's unique skills and interests
- Match talents to program needs from day one
- Build genuine belonging, not just membership
- Transform families into pack champions

FIRST IMPRESSIONS — Make the First Contact Count

1. Before They Arrive

Assign a New Family Guide — a current parent who reaches out personally. Send a welcome note.

2. At the First Meeting

Introduce them to leadership AND other families. Give a tour. Name tags for everyone.

3. Skills Discovery

Ask: What do you do?
What are your hobbies?
What do your kids love?

4. Follow Up Fast

Contact within 48 hours.
Share one specific way their skills could help.

SKILLS INVENTORY — Discover What Your New Families Bring

Questions to Ask

- What do you do for work?
- Hobbies or sports your family enjoys?
- Special skills — cooking, crafts, music, tech?
- Scouting or outdoor experience?
- Topics you love to teach kids about?
- Hours per month you could contribute?

Match Skills to Pack Needs

STEM & Tech: *Engineers, IT, science* → STEM activities

Outdoors & Sports: *Hikers, coaches* → camping, nature badges

Arts & Creativity: *Artists, musicians* → Blue & Gold, skits

Business & Finance: *Accountants* → treasurer, fundraising

Health & Safety: *Nurses, EMTs* → First Aid education

Community & Service: *Faith leaders* → service projects, citizenship

INCLUSION STRATEGIES — Building True Belonging

Communication

- Multiple channels: text, email, app
- Pair families with a veteran buddy
- Share a 'What to Expect' guide
- Speak plainly — avoid jargon

Participation

- Invite opinions at committee meetings
- Ask parents to co-lead one activity
- Create low-barrier entry roles first
- Let families shape the program calendar

Belonging

- Learn every family's name quickly
- Acknowledge cultural backgrounds
- Check in monthly with new families
- Share how their involvement helped

VOLUNTEER ROLES — Matching People to Roles That Fit

Key roles: Den Leader (High), Assistant Den Leader (Medium), Cubmaster (High), Treasurer (Low-Med), Event Coordinator (Flexible), STEM/Activity Lead (One-time), New Family Liaison (Low). Show families the full menu — not just Den Leader.

ENGAGING PARTICIPATION — Practical Tips for Pack Leaders

Do This — It Works

- Ask 'What do you love doing?' before 'Can you help?'
- Give small specific asks — not a vague call for help
- Publicly thank new volunteers at pack meetings
- Invite them to shadow a leader before committing
- Create 'no pressure' pilot opportunities

Avoid These Mistakes

- Dumping all info at once at the first meeting
- Assigning roles based on availability not interest
- Only contacting families when you need something
- Letting new parents fade into the background
- Forgetting to close the loop — share the impact

CREATIVE PROGRAM — Using Family Skills to Elevate Your Pack

A parent is a chef →

Outdoor cooking Adventure that wows every Scout

A parent is a veteran →

Flag ceremony training and Citizenship focus

A parent is an engineer →

STEM night with real hands-on builds

A parent is an artist →

Pinewood Derby design workshop for all Scouts

A parent is a musician →

Pack meeting songs and Blue & Gold entertainment

A parent is an EMT →

First Aid Adventure taught by a real pro

30/60/90-DAY ONBOARDING PLAN

Day 1-30: Welcome & Discover

- Personal welcome from a current family
- Skills inventory conversation
- Buddy family assignment
- YPT training reminder
- Share pack calendar + next steps

Day 31-60: Engage & Participate

- Assign first skill-matched role
- Invite to shadow a den meeting
- Include in one pack event planning
- Recognize contribution at pack meeting
- Check in: How is it going?

Day 61-90: Belong & Lead

- Offer position-specific training
- Connect with pack committee
- Lead or co-lead one activity
- Share impact of their involvement
- Ask: What else would you like to do?

RESOURCES & NEXT STEPS

Take Action This Week

1. Create or update a Skills Inventory form
2. Identify one parent as New Family Liaison
3. Review your volunteer roster for gaps
4. Audit next 3 pack meetings for involvement

Official Resources

- my.scouting.org — Training, records, registration
- [Scoutbook.scouting.org](https://scoutbook.scouting.org) — Advancement tracking
- scouting.org/training — All volunteer training
- scouting.org/training/youth-protection — YPT

5. Send a personal welcome to recently joined families

- Scouting App (iOS/Android) — Communication hub

ENGAGE • INCLUDE • EMPOWER

When new families are truly welcomed, their skills discovered, and their contributions celebrated — everyone wins.